

Strengths and weaknesses of the game you have developed:

One of the greatest strengths that came with our team was our modular development style. Each member had their own core areas that they focused on handling (For example Customers, Appliances, Sabotages). This increased rapid experimentation and feature implementation as less consensus was needed when you lead your own module.

Modular development also created weaknesses, especially around integration. Module inter-dependencies often led to bottlenecks or “dependency chaining”. For example, Person A might be unable to finish their module until they received code from Person B, who was also waiting on their own code from Person C. This indicates that we probably should have looked into strategies to address this issue.

Another weakness of our modular approach was knowledge redundancy. Our vision for multiplayer for example required most team members to spend significant time learning client-server interactions. While this knowledge is valuable long-term, it was inefficient given our limited time budget. Appointing a few specialists to spearhead this area could have allowed for faster development.

Finally ending with one more strength of our team, I want to mention our overall ease of agreement. When it came to deciding on ideas to implement, code changes or choosing what to include in milestones, all team members seemed to be able to have their say and had no major conflicts regarding co-operation. Overall, this lack of friction was significant in helping us move forward quickly.

Discussion of best parts of the game/development process as a group:

One of the best parts of our group development process was our in-person meetings. These proved key for discussing bugs, as members could showcase issues in real-time. Furthermore, if the game crashed on a specific line of code, we could have each person instantly check if it was their module. This allowed us to quickly decide whether to fix it immediately or to schedule it for a later point if it was a more serious problem.

Another important part of the process, which we should have done more of from the start, was code reviews. Reviewing each person's code as a group not only provided an opportunity for improvements but, more critically, it allowed the team to build an understanding of what was being done outside of their individual focus points.

Our group's Discord was integral to our development. We used it for scheduling meetings, showcasing work updates, and bringing up small issues. That last point in particular stands out, as it was much more efficient than trying to sync everyone's schedules for a tiny problem, especially when the issue only concerned one or two team members.